

DEAP CAPITAL MANAGEMENT AND TRUST PLC APPOINTS DUTCH LAMON RUTTEN AS CHAIRMAN

Lagos, Nigeria — March 18, 2026

Deap Capital Management & Trust Plc (Deap Capital or the Company) has announced the appointment of **Mr. Lamon Rutten** as **Chairman of the Board**, following the company's recent 12th Annual General Meeting and subsequent inaugural Board meeting held on 12th March 2026 by the newly constituted Board.

Mr. Rutten is a globally respected expert in commodity markets, structured commodity finance, and exchange development, bringing more than thirty (30) years of international experience across Europe, Asia, the Middle East, and Africa.

Lamon, a Dutch national with extensive experience in Middle East, Africa and South Asia, holds a master's degree with honours in International Economic Management from Tilburg University, Netherlands. He is widely reputed as a pioneer in the development of modern commodity trading and financing infrastructure worldwide having served at Chie of Energy at the United Nations.

Mr. Rutten previously served as pioneering **Chief Executive Officer** of the **Multi Commodity Exchange of India (MCX)** also known as the Mumbai Commodity Exchange, where he led the exchange through a period of significant growth and quantum leap, establishing it as **the world's second largest commodity exchanges**. Under his leadership, MCX achieved a landmark **public listing valued at approximately \$1.5 billion** and a revenue of over \$2.5 trillion by 2012.

He has also held several high-profile leadership and advisory roles globally, including serving as **Founding CEO of the Indonesia Commodity & Derivatives Exchange (ICDX)** and playing a key role in the development of the **Saudi Mining Exchange initiative**. Earlier in his career, he worked with the **United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD)** where he led international program focused on commodity risk management and structured trade finance.

Mr. Rutten is also a prolific author and policy expert, having published **numerous research papers and policy works on commodity markets, trade finance, and risk management**, and has advised governments, multilateral institutions, and financial organization on commodity market development.

Commenting on the appointment, Dr. Israel Ovirih, President of the Company, stated:

"We are pleased to welcome Lamon Rutten as Chairman of Deap Capital Management and Trust Plc. His extensive global experience in commodity markets and financial infrastructure development will be instrumental in guiding the Company as we build a world-class platform to finance and support the growth of the critical minerals sector across continental Africa."

He stated further that, "The new chairman and his global experience should enable the unleashing of new possibilities in the African metals and minerals space, including bringing new thoughts on how to modern and formalize artisanal mining specifically in Nigeria"

Commenting on his appointment, Mr. Lamon Rutten, the new Chairman, stated

"It's a new dawn for the African metals and minerals financing space; I appreciate my colleagues unanimous decision asking me to chair the new board, the future starts now"

Mr. Rutten's appointment further strengthens Deap Capital Management and Trust Plc's leadership as the company advances its mission of **mobilizing capital and building financial solutions to unlock Africa's critical mineral potential**, positioning the organization as a strategic bridge between global investors and Africa's emerging resource economy.



Osammor Otiono & Co.

Company Secretary

Deap Capital Management and Trust Plc

Lagos, Nigeria